

I Can

I cannot walk or run or play a game of tennis everyday. I cannot dance or ride a bike, I'll never know what skating's like. I have no soccer boots or ball, they are no use to me at all. I'll never ski the waves or snow, so many thrills I'll never know. I'll never sail the wind or surf, nor climb the snow capped peaks above, so many things I'll never love. But I can ride through forest trails to see the fox and rabbit tails, and watch the geese and ducks take flight, while leaping stags and deer take flight. And I can follow mountain tracks, past climbers weighted down with packs, to trace a river to its source, astride the broad back of a horse. Yes, I enjoy the "sport of kings" when carried high my feet take wings. To fly me on a pleasure course, for I can mount and ride a horse.

Written by a student

Get Involved

We rely entirely on volunteers and donations to serve our riders.

Volunteer • Donate • Refer a Rider

By Phone

• Volunteer or Refer a Rider

231-883-1221

• Donate

231-487-8211 or 912-501-2855

Online

www.exceptionalridersprogram.org

Email

exceptionalridersprogram@gmail.com

By Mail

P.O. Box 292, Petoskey, MI 49770

Make checks payable to:

Exceptional Riders Program, Inc.



@exceptionalridersprogram



EXCEPTIONAL RIDERS PROGRAM

Therapeutic Horseback Riding for Individuals with Special Needs

Building strength, confidence,
and independence—one ride
at a time.



Who We Are

Founded in 1983, Exceptional Riders Program is a nonprofit providing therapeutic horseback riding for individuals with physical, emotional, and cognitive disabilities.

- PATH International–accredited program
- PATH-certified instructors
- Trained volunteers & trusted horses
- Lessons provided **free of charge**



How Therapeutic Riding Helps

Riders benefit physically, emotionally, and socially through structured, safe instruction.

- Improves balance, coordination, and strength
- Builds confidence and independence
- Encourages social connection and joy

Each rider receives individualized goals based on ability and experience.

“I can mount and ride a horse.”
— Exceptional Riders student

Program Sessions

- Spring and Fall
- 8-week sessions
- 1 night per week
- 1-hour mounted lessons

Lessons focus on real riding skills, not pony rides.

